

Clinical Utilization Guideline: Total Knee Arthroplasty (TKA)

Guideline Reference: ODG-MSK-0417 | Revision: 3.2 | Last Reviewed: 03/2026

Applicable Codes

Code Type	Code	Description
CPT	27447	Total knee arthroplasty, with or without patella resurfacing
CPT	27486	Revision of total knee arthroplasty, one component
ICD-10	M17.11	Unilateral primary osteoarthritis, right knee
ICD-10	M17.12	Unilateral primary osteoarthritis, left knee
ICD-10	M17.0	Bilateral primary osteoarthritis of knee

Medical Necessity Criteria

- Radiographic confirmation of Kellgren-Lawrence Grade 3 or 4 osteoarthritis, OR post-traumatic arthritis, OR avascular necrosis with collapse.
- Documented failure of at least 3 months of conservative management, including physical therapy, NSAIDs (unless contraindicated), and at least one intra-articular injection (corticosteroid or viscosupplementation).
- Persistent pain and functional limitation significantly affecting activities of daily living, with a documented functional outcome score (e.g., Oxford Knee Score ≤ 25 or WOMAC ≥ 40).
- BMI documented; if BMI > 40, case requires additional surgical risk review prior to authorization.
- No active systemic or local infection at the surgical site.
- Patient has been informed of risks, benefits, and alternatives, with documented informed consent discussion.

Exclusions / Additional Review Triggers

- Age under 40 without clear traumatic etiology - refer to peer review.
- Less than 3 months of documented conservative treatment - request additional records.
- Uncontrolled diabetes (HbA1c > 8.0%) - refer to peer review for surgical risk assessment.
- Active tobacco use without cessation counseling documented - flag for case management.

Expected Length of Disability / Recovery

Typical return-to-sedentary-work timeframe: 6-8 weeks post-operatively. Typical return to medium/heavy manual labor: 12-16 weeks, contingent on physical therapy progress and functional capacity evaluation (FCE) results.

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